BGIN Business Meeting

BGIN Block 15 · Georgetown University Capitol Campus, 111 Massachusetts Avenue NW, Washington, D.C.

Date	15 October 2026
Room	Room A (2424)
Published time	17:10–18:00
Workstream	BGIN calendar and GDC
Status	Draft for working-group review. Source: closed captions.
Rule	Chatham House Rule. Information may be used without revealing the identity or affiliation of speakers or other participants, directly or indirectly.

This is a session record, not a transcript. Substantive discussion is retained with uncertainty and disagreement made explicit. Reported claims are not verified findings. Candidate agreements require working-group confirmation before use as decisions. Actions omit personal owners and identifying roles.

Agreements

The following sentences stand on their own. These are candidate agreements and reported points of convergence for working-group review. Inclusion does not establish consensus, verify a technical claim, or record formal adoption. The working group must confirm each decision before it is cited as such. Claims that were only discussed, including figures and alternatives that were not adopted, remain in full under Discussion.

Two Block meetings a year, not three. The January GDC high-level meeting is not a BGIN Block.

BGIN intends to return to GDC next year as a co-organizer, on the same footing as this year, and to seek a standing relationship. The Swiss nonprofit umbrella is the organizers' plan, not a BGIN restructuring.

The meeting lead's calendar, stated to the room and used for the next-meeting announcement: Tokyo at the end of February (Japan Fintech Week window), with an announcement as soon as possible. Geneva in September was the paired proposal and was not separately voted.

The Block's days must not clash with GDC. BGIN presents at GDC. Ask the organizers for the cost of an extra day.

SSO workshop: the meeting lead will propose extended abstracts in a work-in-progress session, separate from LNCS full papers. One-day shape to propose: two regular-paper slots, one work-in-progress session, one panel. Full-paper cutoff remains the Springer date (end of October / Monday).

PQC: BGIN runs a technology evaluation the Japanese government side cannot staff; a global test bed; evaluation starts next year. Morning discussion was not reopened.

Entity work, if it proceeds, includes the constitution and chair structure, because a US nonprofit filing would require current documents. Get advice before setting up. W3C's multi-entity pattern was only a

comparison.

Sponsors thanked. Day 2 starts at 09:00 with a keynote. Reception followed, with no decisions.

Documents considered

The session referred to the following documents, repositories, and standards. Bibliographic identifications and factual checks added during review are marked as editorial clarifications; they do not imply that the links were spoken or that the meeting adopted the findings. Names of the people who introduced the material are omitted.

GDC meeting report, edited by BGIN, described as downloadable. Three BGIN sessions, including PQC migration. No URL was spoken.

OpenWallet Foundation as the origin of GDC; Swiss nonprofit umbrella under consideration; Swiss government representative in the organizer conversation.

Springer LNCS proceedings for the SSO workshop (December conference; end-of-October full-paper deadline).

Constitution and related chair, co-chair, and steering documents, described as last substantially updated in 2020 or 2021. Not quoted.

USDC sponsor-fee path: used for a prior program (caption "program 40"); not available for the current one (caption "program 50").

NIST and other standards bodies, as the preferred submission path. A token paper cited by [unverified: "JDA"].

No Discourse thread, Proof of Control page, or KYA-OS page was discussed in the business meeting or the reception. No posters.

Discussion

The following is the substance of the session. It preserves claims, figures, alternatives, and objections. Discussion does not establish a decision. Any candidate agreement requires explicit working-group confirmation.

Workstream: BGIN business/governance. The first passages repeat the supply-chain close and the 17:10 restart. Below, the business meeting and the reception are separate. No industry or investor session is in this slice.

Business meeting

About 50 minutes were planned. Two items plus future Block meetings: a report on the Global Digital Collaboration conference (GDC), and the PQC competition already discussed that morning, then the calendar.

GDC GDC was described as a global digital collaboration conference, started by the OpenWallet Foundation, and now a multi-party meeting rather than a single organizer's event: on the order of 40 organizations (caption: 47, or 40–48) plus government. Government, international organizations, and industry share one program. Three days. Day one is plenary panels. Days two and three have over 120 breakout sessions. Each co-organizer can propose breakouts on a specific topic. This year's meeting was in September, in Geneva, with over 2,000 people.

BGIN held three sessions, including PQC migration. A meeting report was edited by BGIN and can be downloaded.

Floor report from Geneva:

Visible progress since the OpenWallet Foundation's first GDC. Participants included people from Google Wallet and the Linux Foundation. The mix of open-source developers, providers, and identity practitioners was the point of interest.

GDC is not blockchain-centric. BGIN was described as the blockchain voice among co-organizers.

The AI vulnerability-handling session was full. Red Hat participants approached afterward about the Security Agent work.

GDC was recommended as the mid-cycle place to socialize research and standards work done at Block meetings: Tokyo early in the year, then GDC feedback halfway between the two Blocks.

Initial working relationships were also credited to being in the room.

Organizers were told BGIN wants a deeper relationship. They are looking at a Swiss nonprofit umbrella for the events, with more continuity and a relationship with the Swiss government. That was described as European access BGIN does not get from Tokyo-and-Washington Blocks alone.

The PQC session was one of the few with expertise from outside the wallet industry. A Google Quantum presentation drew interest in BGIN's work.

Conversation with GDC organizers (foundation leadership and a Swiss government representative): a standing relationship and broader cooperation, not only a one-off panel. Support was offered for BGIN's co-organizer process. European footprint was called a large gain. A legal point was made in garbled form: BGIN's own foundation is not strong, and a relationship with the other foundation might be usable from a legal standpoint. That was not a decision to merge or to rely on the Swiss vehicle.

Intention stated: BGIN participates in GDC next year in the same way as this year. It was explicitly "not a promise," then restated as what BGIN will do.

Calendar proposal The meeting lead proposed a full Block co-located with GDC, citing 2,000 participants and overlap on identity and data topics, as a way to bring outside experts. Participants living in Switzerland, Germany, and the United Kingdom were part of the rationale. Washington over the last three or four years, including this week, was described as comfortable, but Geneva was argued to reach more technology experts. It was framed as a trial for next year.

Clarifying question from the room: does GDC collaboration replace co-location with Japan Fintech

Week, or add a third Block, on top of Tokyo and Washington?

Answer given:

Keep two Block meetings a year.

Spring Block in Japan.

Fall Block in Geneva.

No Washington Block next year.

Dates stated: end of February in Tokyo, and September in Geneva.

The January high-level meeting is a GDC meeting, not a BGIN Block. BGIN can sit in it as a co-organizer, under that umbrella. It was described as a limited "layer 2" liaison meeting.

Tradeoffs raised, not resolved:

Washington community and resources would be lost. If the trade is made, 2028 might return to Washington on an alternate year.

A non-Block presence at DC Fintech Week could improve the relationship with the Privacy Summit, because BGIN would not be competing for the same days. That presence was sketched as a layer-2 or a small meeting, about 8 to 20 people, on one or two topics.

IMF meetings are in Singapore this year, not Washington. In earlier years, overlap with the Washington Block brought IMF participants. Moving the fall Block to Geneva drops that overlap.

The Block must not sit on the same days as GDC. BGIN would also present inside GDC. A breakout slot could be borrowed. Thursday was suggested as the Block day, with GDC's largest topics on Friday, and an ask that GDC extend the stay so people can come into the Block. A Friday Block was also called reasonable. Post-meeting clarification (19 October 2026): the extra day is a BGIN Block meeting alongside GDC, which BGIN would host and run. Its event budget and arrangements still need to be established; this is not a confirmed free additional GDC day.

Alternative venue, if a Crypto Village relationship is used: Zurich, possibly an Ethereum Foundation venue. Noted as a different city, not adopted.

The meeting lead closed this portion as a proposal still being finished, with about 15 minutes left in the item.

PQC competition The morning had already spent about half a day on it; details were not reopened. Substance restated:

A Japanese government sponsor can put up a global activity but does not have the capacity to run the technology evaluation, and is asking BGIN to do that evaluation.

BGIN will organize a global test bed. Evaluation starts next year.

The caption does not establish a funding amount. Post-meeting planning clarification (19 October 2026): approximately US$10,000 is the current estimate for PQC testbed nodes. This is an indicative

estimate, not an approved meeting budget.

It was called proof that BGIN can affect something outside its own papers.

Influence path, from the floor:

BGIN's influence so far has been papers submitted to government. One token paper was said to have been cited in policy documents by [unverified body: "JDA"].

Two routes: submit into standards committees that already reach governments, or write BGIN's own standards. The second was called harder.

BGIN is already talking to NIST and other major standards bodies, and should fit what those bodies are trying to research.

Conference papers and attendance were the other route.

Influence was described as real in Japan and thin in the United States, Australia, and Europe. The gap is who carries a paper into those policy processes.

SSO workshop and Springer LNCS As discussed in the morning, there is a co-located workshop with SSO, and the paper deadline was extended. Early the next week was the working window. Proposal, accepted as something to socialize and then as something the meeting lead will formally propose:

Accept extended abstracts as well as full papers, because the extension is short notice.

Reason for the hard date: SSO publishes proceedings with Springer (LNCS), physically available by the December conference. End of October is the strict deadline for the final full-paper version. The caption also said the journal cutoff is Monday.

Extended abstracts would not go into LNCS, so they can have a different deadline.

Short notice was said to be why it is hard to bring in the Ethereum community, among others.

Format if the workshop is one day: two slots for regular papers, one work-in-progress session, one panel. The work-in-progress session is the home for extended abstracts.

The meeting lead committed to propose that split.

Next Block and later years The venue for the next meeting had not been contacted (caption: the public-event venue). Plan: Tokyo, end of February, at the end of the first week of the Japan Fintech Week period; March was also said. Announcement as soon as possible. This is the spring meeting already described above. Geneva was restated as the other next-year meeting, still as a proposal seeking opinion.

One extended view on location, not adopted as a decision:

About six or seven Blocks attended. Alternating Washington and Tokyo has not changed who comes.

Location matters less than organizer time. The current pattern depends on a few people recruiting

personally. Local chairs previously produced larger local turnout. Restoring local chairs, then feeding people into working groups and papers, was the ask. A chapter model (one person per university or region) was sketched.

Sitting beside another conference has not, in this view, raised headcount over the last two years. DC Fintech Week teams did not come across. Co-location can lose to competition for attention. Croatia was the exception, where another conference's participants did attend in force. IFIP, IACR, and similar cryptography meetings were suggested as better neighbors than a generic fintech week.

Europe, the Americas, or Southeast Asia are all acceptable. A Greek island was used as a throwaway. A local chair from a university or from industry was called more important than the city, and as a way to cut the recruitment load.

A 2028 counter-proposal, also not adopted:

Tie 2028 to the PQC competition. Tokyo or Japan in the second half of 2028, when the winner is announced and a prize is given for the chosen migration strategy, would draw more attention than an early-2028 date aimed at fostering competitors.

The Japanese competition agency could be invited to attend and present if the Block is in Tokyo then. "18" in the caption may mean Block 18.

The first-half 2028 Block would then need another place.

Entity, money, constitution BGIN is a nonprofit. A Japan-side vehicle [unverified caption: "DNA"] manages the budget. IPA was named as the Japanese counterpart. The entity question has been open for about two years.

USDC: a prior program (caption: "program 40") could take a sponsor fee in USDC. The current one (caption: "program 50") cannot. A US entity was described as making USDC, and US-source money, easier.

The AI-agent system is on the next day's agenda. Virginia Tech is trying to receive funds for that project. A BGIN US entity would be the question for NSF eligibility.

Floor view: a US entity is attractive, and if the entity is reopened, the constitution and operating documents should be reopened with it. Those documents were described as largely un-updated since 2020 or 2021. Chairs, co-chairs, and the steering committee should be in that review. Agreement in the room: a US nonprofit application would require that paperwork anyway.

Comparison offered: W3C has entities in the United States, Japan, and France. Advice from someone with experience of that kind of organization was offered to the chair and the team. US state nonprofit law was described as hard to navigate without counsel. "5 or 3" in the caption is likely a 501(c)(3) reference and is not clear enough to treat as a decision.

Priority of a US entity was tied, by one view, to winning the vulnerability and Security Agent tender. If that tender fails, the US entity is a lower priority. Another view: NSF or other US federal money matters in its own right, by analogy with early US government support for internet infrastructure, so

advice should be sought anyway. Other grants, in Europe as well as the United States and Japan, and a subsidiary, were also suggested.

A three-part funding sketch, not adopted:

Use the GDC organization to apply for European grants.

Use NSF success, if it comes, as the justification for a US entity.

Use the Japan entity for the PQC relationships and the Japanese funding. If that work produces a crypto-agility standard, use it as evidence in a later US application.

Constraint stated: do the advice on structure, place, and available money before spending large time or large cost. The constitution review was parked as a later topic.

Purpose drift: the original mix (regulated parties, developers, business) is not who attends now. The room was asked what "blockchain governance initiative network" means, why PQC, the security work, and FASE dominate the papers, and how participation grows. Five engaged people producing more documents was described as not the same as relevance. A shake-up, including location, was left open. The GDC opening was welcomed.

Sponsors were thanked. Improving the Block meeting had already been discussed. Day 2 starts at 09:00 in the same pattern as Day 1, opening with a keynote. Confirmation of the next keynote arrangements was requested.

Reception

The business meeting ended by moving the room to a reception. Food had been ordered against an uncertain headcount. No agenda, decision, or working discussion was recorded. Tomorrow morning at 09:00 was repeated.

Matters not resolved

Geneva in place of Washington is a proposal with a clarified shape (still two Blocks; January GDC high-level meeting is not a Block). It was not recorded as a voted decision. Washington loss, IMF overlap, and a possible 2028 return were left open.

Geneva: BGIN would host and run a Block meeting alongside GDC, as clarified after the meeting. The event budget remains to be established. Zurich was an alternative, not a plan.

Thursday versus Friday placement relative to GDC was not settled, except that the Block should not compete with GDC on the same day, and BGIN would still present at GDC.

Whether co-locating with a large conference increases attendance. One view: it has not, except Croatia, and DC Fintech Week did not send people. Local chairs and chapters were the alternative theory.

2028 Tokyo in the second half, aligned with the PQC winner, a prize, and the Japanese competition agency, would force a different first-half site. Not decided.

US entity versus Japan vehicle versus a GDC Swiss umbrella for European grants. Conditional on

the Security Agent tender in one view; worth pursuing for NSF regardless in another. Counsel was requested, not appointed in a recorded decision.

Constitution, chair and co-chair rules, and steering committee: review only if the entity work goes ahead. Documents described as stale since 2020–2021. No review was started.

Who BGIN is for, now that the original regulated / developer / business mix is not the room. How papers reach NIST and other SDOs outside Japan. The [unverified: "JDA"] citation is a single example.

PQC budget figure is not readable from the caption.

Venue for the February Tokyo Block: not yet contacted.

LNCS Monday / end-of-October cutoff versus a later abstract deadline: the split was agreed as a proposal to send, not as a workshop rule already accepted by SSO or Springer.

"Program 40" versus "program 50" and USDC: labels unverified.

Disposition of the work

GDC 2026 (September, Geneva, 2,000+ people, 120+ breakouts) is done. BGIN ran three sessions, including PQC migration and an AI vulnerability-handling session that drew Red Hat interest in the Security Agent. A BGIN-edited GDC report is available. Co-organizer status and a deeper link to the GDC organizers, who are considering a Swiss nonprofit with a government relationship, are in progress. IEEE's co-organizer role this year was mentioned as a path BGIN can follow.

The operating calendar is in transition: two meetings a year remains the rule; Tokyo end of February is the next Block to announce; Washington next year was proposed for removal in favor of Geneva in September; the venue is not booked. 2028 is entirely open.

PQC evaluation is a funded-direction project starting next year, with the amount unclear in this caption. The SSO/LNCS workshop (December, Springer proceedings) has a hard full-paper date and a proposed abstract track.

The legal vehicle is a Japan-side nonprofit whose budget arrangements do not currently take USDC for the program under discussion. A US entity, NSF, the Security Agent tender, European grants via GDC, and a constitution review are one bundle of unfinished governance work. No new entity was created in the meeting.

Actions

Each action is written so that it can be tracked without the rest of the record. Where the room named only a person, the action is kept and the name is omitted.

Announce the next Block (Tokyo, end of February / Japan Fintech Week window) as soon as possible, and contact the venue.

Continue the GDC relationship: co-organizer path for next year; cost estimate for an adjacent day; do not schedule the Block on top of GDC; present inside GDC.

Leave the Washington-versus-Geneva trade, any small DC side meeting, Zurich, and the 2028 PQC competition timing for a later decision. Local chairs were a strong request, not a mandate.

Send the SSO proposal: extended abstracts and a work-in-progress session, with LNCS full papers still on the Monday / end-of-October cutoff.

Take advice on entity form, where it would sit, and which grants exist (Japan, NSF, Europe via GDC) before spending the setup cost. Reopen the constitution only as part of that. Treat the Security Agent tender as one input to whether a US entity is urgent.

Confirm the next keynote arrangements against the published programme. The AI-agent funding item is on the next day's agenda.

Develop the PQC testbed node budget using the post-meeting indicative estimate of approximately US$10,000; confirm scope and approval separately.

Coverage

The published business meeting is 17:10–18:00, after the supply-chain session, and the reception follows at 18:00. The captured discussion is the close of the Room A afternoon recording. Day 1 has no industry session on the published programme. Figures are reported session claims, not independently validated measurements. Technical names are corrected where supported by the recording, chat, or identified primary documentation. Where a name could not be checked against another part of the same recording, it is left unverified rather than guessed. Logistics, introductions, and names of speakers are omitted.

The slice file mixes three things. The supply-chain ending is duplicate and is not re-analyzed here. The business meeting covers GDC, the two-meeting calendar, a short PQC status, the SSO abstract proposal, entity and constitution, and who BGIN is for. The reception is only a close of day. No industry session and no investor session appear. Caption quality is poor on money, program numbers, and the Geneva cost. The calendar clarification (not a third Block; January is not a Block; Tokyo end of February; Geneva proposed for September) is the most usable governance result. It should still be read as the meeting lead's proposal as clarified in the room, not as a minuted vote.

Source clarifications and open checks

"JDA" as the body that cited a BGIN token paper.

Japan vehicle "DNA." "5 or 3" as a US tax status. "USAT.".

The garbled funding caption is superseded for planning by the 19 October clarification: approximately US$10,000 for testbed nodes, indicative and not a meeting-approved commitment.

"Program 40" and "program 50.".

Block "18" in the 2028 suggestion.

Co-organizer count "47 or 40 or 48.".

The extra Geneva day means a BGIN-hosted Block meeting alongside GDC. Budget and venue arrangements remain open.